NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 4 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1933–1939

Key Topic 4: Life in Nazi Germany, 1933–39

Nazi Policies Towards Women, Youth, Standard of Living & Persecution of Minorities



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • SEPTEMBER 1938

Hitler Youth Review at the Nuremberg Party Congress

Over 50,000 members of the Hitlerjugend parade before Hitler, reflecting the total militarisation of German children. Accession Shelfmark BA 183-1987-0703-508.

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION 31 • KEY TOPIC 4 CONTENT OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 Nazi Policies Towards Women

- Nazi views on women and the family.
- Nazi policies towards women, including marriage and family, employment and appearance.

2 Nazi Policies Towards the Young

- Nazi aims and policies towards the young. The Hitler Youth and the League of German Maidens.
- Nazi control of the young through education, including the curriculum and teachers.

3 Employment and Living Standards

- Nazi policies to reduce unemployment: labour service, autobahns, rearmament and invisible unemployment.
- Changes in the standard of living, especially of German workers. The Labour Front, Strength Through Joy, Beauty of Labour.

4 The Persecution of Minorities

- Nazi racial beliefs and policies and the treatment of minority groups: Slavs, Roma and Sinti, homosexuals, and people with disabilities.
- The persecution of Jewish people, including the boycott of Jewish shops and businesses (1933), the **Nuremberg Laws** and '**Kristallnacht**'.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 4)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

JUN 1933 • Law for the Encouragement of Marriage

KEY TOPIC 4.1

The Nazi state offers marriage loans of up to 1,000 marks to newlywed Aryan couples, provided the bride gives up her job. For each child born, 25% of the loan is permanently cancelled, boosting the national birth rate.

15 SEP 1935 • Enactment of the Nuremberg Racial Laws

KEY TOPIC 4.4

Announced at the Nuremberg Rally, the Reich Citizenship Law strips German Jews of citizenship and voting rights. The Law for the Protection of German Blood and Honour makes marriage and sexual relations between Jews and Aryans illegal.

MAR 1935 • Introduction of Military Conscription & Rearmament

KEY TOPIC 4.3

Hitler openly renounces the Versailles disarmament clauses, announcing a peacetime army of 550,000 men and the creation of the Luftwaffe. Massive military rearmament absorbs hundreds of thousands of unemployed German workers.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 4)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

DEC 1936 • First Hitler Youth Law Passed

KEY TOPIC 4.2

All non-Nazi youth organisations (Catholic and sporting clubs) are banned or absorbed. Membership of the Hitlerjugend becomes effectively expected for all children aged 10–18, and is made strictly compulsory in March 1939.

9–10 NOV 1938 • Kristallnacht (The Night of Broken Glass)

KEY TOPIC 4.4

Following the assassination of diplomat Ernst vom Rath in Paris, Goebbels unleashes nationwide anti-Jewish pogroms. SA and SS mobs burn over 1,000 synagogues, destroy 7,500 Jewish businesses, murder 91 Jews, and send 30,000 Jewish men to concentration camps.

1 SEP 1939 • Invasion of Poland & Outbreak of War

KEY TOPIC 4.3

Germany invades Poland, triggering World War Two in Europe. The four-year drive for economic autarky (self-sufficiency) shifts into total war mobilization, and persecution of minorities escalates toward mass deportation and murder.

How and why did Nazi policies attempt to restrict women to traditional roles, and why did this policy reverse after 1937?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the regime attempt to remove women from public professions?

- 'Kinder, Küche, Kirche'
- Traditional domestic roles
- Rejection of Weimar 'New Woman'

2 • How were financial loans used to encourage childbearing and lower unemployment?

- 1933 Marriage Loan Act
- 1,000-mark marriage coupons
- 25% loan forgiveness per child

3 • How did honors and breeding centres aim to expand the Aryan population?

- Mother's Cross medals
- Gold cross (8 children)
- Lebensborn maternity program

4 • How did eugenics legislation enforce biological selection on German families?

- 1933 Hereditary Health Act
- Forced sterilization law
- 400,000 citizens sterilized

5 • Why did the Four-Year Plan force the regime to abandon its domestic ideology?

- Four-Year Plan rearmament
- Duty Year labour service
- Women factory workers expand

"Hitler Youth: Compulsory by 1939; boys trained for the battlefield, girls trained for domesticity."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why Nazi policies towards women changed in the years 1933–1939. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The slogan Kinder, Küche, Kirche • The demands of the rearmament economy after 1937 *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 6)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 4.1). In the drawing box, sketch a Mother's Cross medal alongside a woman working a lathe in a munitions factory. Annotate the contradiction between domestic ideology and military labour demands. [ ] Done

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about Nazi propaganda aimed at German mothers.

SOURCE A *From an official Nazi propaganda booklet, The German Mother and Her Children, published in Berlin, 1936.*

"The German woman does not long for the vote or the office desk. Her holy mission is the creation and preservation of the German family. She must be the source of strength for her husband and the teacher of heroic values to her sons, sending healthy soldiers to serve the Führer."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How did the Nazi regime use schooling, teacher purges, and youth organisations to indoctrinate German children?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the Hitler Youth prepare boys for future conscription and combat?

- Hitlerjugend for boys
- Military drill & camping
- Preparation for armed forces

2 • How did the BDM train adolescent girls for motherhood and domestic duty?

- Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM)
- Motherhood & domestic training
- Racial hygiene instruction

3 • Why did the regime make youth group attendance legally compulsory in 1939?

- 1936 Hitler Youth Act
- Compulsory membership (1939)
- Church youth organizations banned

4 • How did the regime ensure that school teachers actively delivered propaganda?

- National Socialist Teachers League
- Jewish teachers sacked (1933)
- Ideological summer camps

5 • How were academic subjects rewritten to reinforce racial theory and militarism?

- Rewritten school textbooks
- Racial biology & Eugenics
- Napolas elite cadet schools

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Nazi regime placed such high importance on controlling the youth in the years 1933–1939. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The Hitler Youth and BDM • Changes to the school curriculum ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 9)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 4.2). In the drawing box, sketch a Hitler Youth boy practicing rifle shooting alongside a school mathematics textbook showing bombing trajectory calculations. Annotate how education was completely militarized. [ ] Done

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE B** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source B about physical training in the Hitler Youth.

SOURCE B *From an account by a former Hitler Youth member, written after the war.*

"We were out in all weathers, marching twenty miles with sixty-pound packs until our boots were full of blood. Weaklings were ridiculed before the whole squad. Everything was competition: obstacle courses, wrestling, bayonet practice. They told us that German boys must be swift as greyhounds, tough as leather, and hard as Krupp steel."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE B that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE B that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Did the standard of living improve for German workers under Nazi rule between 1933 and 1939?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the DAF destroy independent collective bargaining for wages?

- Trade unions abolished (May 1933)
- German Labour Front (DAF)
- Strikes banned & wages frozen

2 • How did public works and motorway construction artificially reduce jobless figures?

- Reich Labour Service (RAD)
- Six months compulsory labour
- Autobahn highway construction

3 • Why was the Nazi claim of full employment statistically misleading?

- Military conscription reintroduced
- 'Invisible unemployment' stats
- Women and Jews excluded

4 • How did leisure schemes compensate workers for lost political rights?

- Kraft durch Freude (KdF)
- Subsidized cruises & theater
- Volkswagen Beetle savings scheme

5 • How did total rearmament erode real worker purchasing power by 1939?

- Four-Year Plan (1936)
- Autarky economic self-sufficiency
- Longer hours & food rationing

"Strength Through Joy (KdF): Cheap theatre tickets and cruises, but the Volkswagen car scheme was a con."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the standard of living for German workers changed in the years 1933–1939. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The German Labour Front (DAF) and KdF • The impact of rearmament and public works *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 12)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 4.3). In the drawing box, sketch a worker shoveling on an autobahn construction site alongside a KdF cruise brochure. Annotate how full employment was paired with long hours and lost strike rights. [ ] Done

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE C** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source C about the conditions experienced by German workers under the Nazi regime.

SOURCE C *From a secret report on working-class morale compiled for the outlawed SPD party in exile (Sopade), 1937.*

"While the official newspapers celebrate the disappearance of unemployment, the reality inside the factories is grim. Men work ten to twelve hours a day without overtime pay, and any complaint to the Labour Front is treated as sabotage. However, the regime keeps grumbling in check by offering subsidized theatre tickets and weekend excursions through Strength Through Joy, which many young workers genuinely welcome."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE C that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE C that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How and why did Nazi persecution of Jews and other minority groups escalate between 1933 and 1939?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the regime initiate public state-sponsored antisemitic discrimination?

- Aryan 'Herrenvolk' ideology
- April 1933 shop boycott
- Jewish civil servants purged

2 • Why did the Nuremberg Laws turn antisemitism into legal statute?

- Nuremberg Laws (1935)
- Reich Citizenship Act
- German Blood Protection Law

3 • How did racial hygiene theories target groups outside the racial community?

- Roma Gypsy persecution
- Pink triangle homosexual arrests
- Euthanasia T4 program origins

4 • How did the November pogrom mark a decisive shift toward violent state terror?

- Kristallnacht pogrom (1938)
- Synagogues burnt & shops looted
- 30,000 Jewish men sent to camps

5 • How did the regime eliminate all remaining Jewish participation in economic life?

- 1 billion mark collective fine
- Jewish businesses 'Aryanized'
- Central Emigration Office expulsions

"April 1933 Boycott: SA stood outside Jewish shops; the first state-sponsored step toward the Holocaust."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the persecution of Jews and other minorities escalated in Nazi Germany in the years 1933–1939. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The Nuremberg Laws (1935) • The events of Kristallnacht (1938) *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 15)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 4.4). In the drawing box, sketch a Jewish shopfront daubed with "Jude" alongside the burning synagogues of Kristallnacht. Annotate the escalation from economic boycotts to violent state pogroms. [ ] Done

"Nuremberg Laws 1935: Stripped German Jews of citizenship and outlawed marriage with Aryans."

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE D** 4 MARKS • 5 MINS Score: [/ 4]

Give two things you can infer from Source D about the destruction caused during Kristallnacht in November 1938.

SOURCE D *From an eyewitness account by a British consular official in Leipzig, 11 November 1938.*

"The devastation in the city centre is appalling. Shattered glass from Jewish-owned shops covers the pavements like gravel, and ancient synagogues have been reduced to smoking ruins while fire brigades stood by merely protecting adjacent Aryan buildings. Crowds of terrified families huddled in side streets as stormtroopers marched past carrying looted goods and dragging shopkeepers toward waiting police vans."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE D that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE D that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Question 3(a): Source Utility [8 marks • 12 mins]

SOURCE B

Front-page article in the Nazi newspaper Völkischer Beobachter, 3 May 1933

From the official Nazi Party newspaper, published the day after SA stormtroopers raided and dissolved all independent German trade unions, May 1933.

"German workers! Your trade unions were corrupted by Marxist class hatred. Today, the National Socialist state has liberated you! By order of the Führer, the German Labour Front (DAF) under Dr. Robert Ley has assumed leadership of all working Germans. Henceforth, employers and workers are united as comrades in the service of the nation. Strike and lockout are abolished forever!"

SOURCE C

Contemporary photograph of Reich Labour Service (RAD) workers building an Autobahn, 1936



From a photograph published in a German magazine, 1936. It shows young men of the Reich Labour Service (RAD) clearing ground for the construction of a new autobahn.

Under the Reich Labour Service Law of June 1935, all young men aged 18 to 25 were compelled to serve six months in the RAD before entering the military. They lived in military-style barracks, wore uniforms, and performed hard manual labour—draining wetlands, planting forests, and building motorways—for pocket money rather than a regular wage.

Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the standard of living of German workers in the years 1933–1939? [8 marks]

Assessment Formula: Evaluate Content + Provenance (Author, Motive, Date) with contextual knowledge for Source B, then Source C.

Evaluate Source B (Content & Provenance on the German Labour Front, abolition of unions, and promises to workers): ***(Source C evaluation continues on Page 17)***

QUESTION 3(A) CONTINUED: EVALUATE SOURCE C (CONTENT & PROVENANCE ON COMPULSORY MANUAL LABOUR, THE RAD, AND WORKING CONDITIONS): **Score: [/ 8]**

HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS 1 AND 2

Target: How and why historians differ (AO4)

INTERPRETATION 1

From an account by historian Richard Grunberger, A Social History of the Third Reich (1971)

"For the vast majority of German industrial workers, the Nazi era brought tangible improvements in everyday life. Unemployment was eliminated within four years, replacing the terror of the Great Depression with guaranteed employment and steady earnings. Through the 'Strength Through Joy' (KdF) organization, millions of ordinary workers enjoyed subsidised theatre tickets, sports facilities, and cruise holidays to Norway and Italy that had previously been the exclusive preserve of the rich. The 'Beauty of Labour' campaign renovated factory canteens, washrooms, and ventilation, creating genuinely improved working conditions."

INTERPRETATION 2

From an account by historian Tim Mason, Social Policy in the Third Reich (1993)

"The claim that German workers experienced a higher standard of living under National Socialism is thoroughly misleading. In return for full employment, workers surrendered all basic rights and freedoms. Real wages remained below 1928 levels while compulsory deductions for the Labour Front, winter relief, and state insurance consumed up to thirty percent of pay packets. Furthermore, the average working week rose from forty-three hours in 1933 to forty-seven hours in 1939. Stripped of the right to strike and tied to their jobs by the Labour Book, workers suffered declining living standards."

Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the standard of living of German workers in the years 1933–1939. What is the main difference between these views? [4 marks] **Score: [/ 4]**

Mark Scheme Law: Identify the fundamental difference in emphasis, then back up each view with direct quotes or specific details from both interpretations.

Question 3(c): Why Views Differ [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the standard of living of German workers in the years 1933–1939. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. [4 marks]

Examiner Guidance: AO4 [4 marks]: Explain differing focus on official leisure initiatives (KdF/DAF promises in Source B) vs regimented manual labour and loss of rights (Source C).

QUESTION 3(D) ESSAY PLANNING & CRITERIA SETUP

16 Marks + 4 SPaG = 20 Marks • 25 Mins

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the standard of living of German workers in the years 1933–1939? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. [16 marks + 4 SPaG]

Thesis Prompt: Formulate your sustained thesis: Did the standard of living for German workers improve through full employment and Strength Through Joy, or did it deteriorate through the destruction of trade unions, longer hours, and frozen wages?

Criteria Planning Canvas: Establish criteria benchmark, map quotes from Int 1 & Int 2, and outline your verdict:

(Essay continues on Page 19)

Level 4 Target (13–16 Marks): Balanced analysis of both views • Sustained contextual knowledge • Justified criteria-led judgment.

SPaG: 4/4 MARKS

Question 3(d): Evaluative Essay on Historical Interpretations

AO4: [/ 16] | SPaG: [/ 4] | Total: [/ 20]

[16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 20 MARKS • TIMED ESSAY: 25 MINS]

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the standard of living of German workers in the years 1933–1939? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. [16 marks + 4 SPaG]

Write your response in the space provided below:

Band 4 Criteria Check:	[ ] Criteria Established	[ ] Both Ints Explored	[ ] Precise Own Knowledge	[ ] Justified Verdict	**Teacher Sign-off:** _____

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 4 TRACKER

Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–1939 (Life in Nazi Germany, 1933–39)

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

#	ENQUIRY / ASSESSMENT UNIT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1 INFER (4M)	Q2 EXPLAIN (12M)	MODULE TOTAL
1	**KT4.1: Nazi Policies Towards Women** *"How and why did Nazi policies attempt to restrict women to traditional roles, and why did this policy reverse after 1937?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
2	**KT4.2: Nazi Policies Towards the Young** *"How did the Nazi regime use schooling, teacher purges, and youth organisations to indoctrinate German children?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
3	**KT4.3: Employment and Living Standards** *"Did the standard of living improve for German workers under Nazi rule between 1933 and 1939?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
4	**KT4.4: The Persecution of Minorities** *"How and why did Nazi persecution of Jews and other minority groups escalate between 1933 and 1939?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
★	**Section B Capstone Assessment (pp. 16–19)** *Q3(a) Utility [8m] • Q3(b) Study Views [4m] • Q3(c) Why Differ [4m] • Q3(d) Evaluative Essay [20m]*	Q3(a): / 8	Q3(b): / 4	Q3(c): / 4 • Q3(d): / 20	/ 36
KEY TOPIC 4 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		**Do Now: / 40**	**Q1 Infer: / 16**	**Q2 Cause: / 48**	**/ 140**

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

_____

Teacher Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • 20-QUESTION PRACTICE QUIZZES

Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive 20-question self-marking quizzes

KT 4.1	KT 4.2	KT 4.3	KT 4.4
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: / 20	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**